

MScAC Initiative Budget Proposal

Event: MScAC Cohort Day Trip — Toronto Islands

Date: Friday, September 4, 2026, 11:00 AM to 5:30 PM

Venue: Toronto Islands (Ward's Island and Centre Island); lunch at The Riviera ~ Ward's Island Kitchen, 102 Lakeshore Ave, Ward's Island; round-trip ferry from the Jack Layton Ferry Terminal, 9 Queens Quay W

Estimated Attendance: 15–20 students

Purpose

A low-structure day off-campus early in the term gives the cohort time to decompress and bond before coursework ramps up. The islands suit this because the day has no schedule to manage — the group wanders the beaches, boardwalk, and gardens at its own pace and regroups for a shared meal. A poll in the cohort Discord server drew 15–20 students saying yes to the Friday date.

Event Components

Travel & Ferry Crossing (11:00 AM – 11:45 AM):

- The group meets at the Jack Layton Ferry Terminal, 9 Queens Quay W.
- Tuan Khai Nguyen holds the pre-purchased Ward's Island round-trip tickets for the whole group; online ticket holders use the express boarding line.
- The crossing to Ward's Island takes about 15 minutes.

Morning Wander — Ward's Island (11:45 AM – 1:15 PM):

- The group explores the Ward's Island village lanes, the boardwalk, and the beach.
- It drifts west along the shared path toward Centre Island at its own pace.

Lunch at The Riviera ~ Ward's Island Kitchen (1:15 PM – 2:45 PM):

- The restaurant sits about a 7-minute walk from the Ward's Island dock.
- Tuan Khai arranges a curated group menu for 15–20 people with the restaurant by email or phone in advance, places the group order on the day, and settles one itemized bill on one card.
- Several cohort members are vegetarian and some are vegan, and The Riviera's kitchen makes vegan, vegetarian, and gluten-free dishes (gluten-free vegan lasagna, Beyond Meat burger, wood-oven vegetable pizza, Buddha bowl); the booking confirms the vegan, vegetarian, and gluten-free counts and names their substitutions on the group menu.
- All beverages purchased are non-alcoholic; the restaurant is licensed, but no alcohol is bought or reimbursed.

Afternoon Exploring — Centre Island (2:45 PM – 4:45 PM):

- The group takes in the Avenue of the Islands, the formal gardens, the pier, and the Franklin Children's Garden.
- The group may continue to Hanlan's Point beach if time allows.

Return (4:45 PM – 5:30 PM):

- The group takes the ferry back to the mainland from the Ward's Island or Centre Island dock.

Budget Breakdown

Item Description	Quantity	Estimated Cost	Per-Person Estimate
Lunch: Curated group menu at The Riviera ~ Ward's Island Kitchen (102 Lakeshore Ave, Ward's Island) — one main + one non-alcoholic drink per person, incl. 13% HST and ~20% gratuity; one reservation, paid as one itemized bill	For 20 people	\$600	\$30.00
Ferry: Round-trip Toronto Island ferry tickets (Ward's Island route), City of Toronto, purchased online in advance; budgeted at the full adult fare of \$9.57/person as a buffer, with the 10% group discount on 10+ tickets bringing the actual cost lower	20	\$190	\$9.50

The budget is built for the top of the 15–20 range; at 15 attendees the expected spend is about \$595. Food works out to \$30 per head, below the \$35–40 per-head norm — The Riviera is the only island venue able to serve genuine vegan mains, which the cohort requires. The outing needs no equipment or materials, and there is no venue-rental cost. The total of \$790 sits within the \$800–\$875 single-event precedent — in fact just below it — even with the ferry transport line included, a cost category the on-campus precedents never carried.

RSVP Plan

- **Interest Polling:** A poll in the cohort Discord server recorded 15–20 students saying yes to the Friday date.
- **Preference Tracking:** A Partiful event page collects final RSVPs and confirms the headcount for the ferry tickets and the restaurant reservation.
- **Dietary Needs:** The Partiful page asks about dietary restrictions; the vegan and vegetarian counts are confirmed with The Riviera when the group menu is booked, and vegan and gluten-free mains are named on the confirmed menu for those attendees.
- **Accessibility:** The Partiful page also asks about mobility or accessibility needs; the ferry is wheelchair accessible and the Ward's and Centre Island paths are flat and paved, the walking legs are optional and the route and pace can be shortened, and Tuan Khai arranges accessible ferry loading as needed.

Other Next Steps

- **Reservation:** Tuan Khai Nguyen emails The Riviera (torontoislandrivieraresort@gmail.com / (416) 203-2152) to book the curated group menu for up to 20 people, confirming the per-head price, whether HST and gratuity are included in the quote, single-invoice billing and any deposit, the September weekday hours, and the vegan, vegetarian, and gluten-free substitutions by name.

- **Ferry Tickets:** Tuan Khai Nguyen buys all round-trip Ward's Island tickets online in a single transaction at least a week before the trip, for the 10% group discount on 10+ tickets and express boarding.
- **Weather:** The day is outdoor-dependent, so Tuan Khai Nguyen sets a rain fallback (a later Friday or an indoor cohort activity) and posts it on the Partiful page.
- **Reporting:** Submit all itemized receipts, final attendee list, and invitation for reimbursement. (ESSENTIAL)

Total Budget Requested: \$790